

Pathological emphasis

CommonMark's emphasis algorithm (§6.2) has subtle rules: left-flanking, right-flanking, the rule of 3, intraword underscores, and the interaction between `*` and `_`. These cases are where most lightweight markdown parsers diverge from each other.

The rule of 3

`**foo** bar**baz** quux` should make the first pair emphasise `foo` and the second pair emphasise `baz`, with `bar` between them as plain text.

foo bar**baz** quux

Triple asterisk

`***foo***` should render as nested italic-inside-bold.

foo

Triple in mid-sentence: This is ***strong and italic*** at once.

Triple with mismatched closing

`***foo** bar*` — opens with three, closes with two-then-one. The bold should close at `**`, the italic at the final `*`.

foo *bar*

`*foo **bar***` — opens with one then two, closes with three. Italic closes at the last `*`, bold at the middle pair.

foo **bar**

Adjacent emphasis runs

`**bold1****bold2**` — two adjacent bold runs with no space.

bold1**bold2**

`*italic1**italic2*` — italic opens, italic continues, double asterisk in middle should not become bold.

*italic1**italic2*

Intraword

`snake_case` and `my_python_var` — underscores intraword should stay literal.

These names are common: `snake_case`, *leading_underscore*, *trailing_underscore*, `double__internal`.

`a*b*c` — asterisks intraword DO emphasise, by CommonMark spec.

The word `abc` has an emphasis in the middle.

Emphasis around punctuation

`foo*bar*baz` — emphasis at word boundary inside.

`foobarbaz`

`*$5*` — currency symbol; should NOT emphasise (punctuation flanking rule).

The price is \$5 today.

`*€5*`, `*£5*`, `*¥5*` — currency symbols across regions.

Prices in `€5`, `£5`, `¥5` form should stay literal.

Emphasis spanning a newline

This *italic continues on the next line* and closes.

And **bold spans across a line** in the same way.

Pathological depth

`a b c d e f g h i j i h g f e d c b a` — ten levels of opening, ten levels of closing.

Unmatched

`*unclosed italic should be literal asterisk and the rest of the line is fine.`

`**unclosed bold same story; literal asterisks.`

``unclosed code span — backtick should be literal too.`

Empty

`****` — four asterisks, no content. Should be either four literal asterisks, or empty emphasis (browser does the former, spec says the former).

The bareword `****` has four asterisks.